Goods on Country

A Curious Tractor
May 2026

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Goods on Country

One hand picks. Another writes the order. The path between is not built.

We are building it.

Executive summary

Minderoo has spent a decade building the supply side of First Nations enterprise. Generation One funds the employers. Dream Venture funds the founders. The Indigenous Employment Index measures the parity. Backing Black Business called for an Indigenous-led patient capital fund. First Australians Capital is that fund. QBE put $500,000 into it in April 2024.

The supply side is now funded. The demand side is not.

Goods on Country is that demand-side infrastructure. Australian buyers. First Nations suppliers. A contracted flow of trade between them. The work is measured on the employment parity frame Minderoo commissioned Murawin to build.

The pipeline is not a plan. It is live. $767,000 of trade sits in the register. Seeded from real Xero data. Anchor buyers are named. Suppliers are onboarded. An agent layer runs the reconciliation, the cadence, the invoice drift, the narrative review, nightly.

QBE Foundation named A Curious Tractor in its 2026 Catalysing Impact cohort on 23 March. The Stage 2 grant of up to $400,000 is designed to unlock matched capital. We are inviting Minderoo to be the matched side.

A parallel envelope reached your desk on 1 May. JusticeHub. Community justice infrastructure, same anchor-portfolio method, different market. Two asks, one logic. ACT curates. The funder catalyses. The work carries.

The ask is $900,000 over three years, tapered. The deliverables are an evaluated cohort of anchor buyers, a measured parity outcome, a quarterly acquittal on the Woort Koorliny frame. The full pack follows.

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1. The problem

The Front Project's 2024 report, commissioned with Minderoo's support, puts the bill at $22.3 billion a year. That is what Australian governments spend on late intervention for children and young people under twenty-four. Child protection. Youth justice. Youth unemployment. Homelessness. Mental health. Family violence. Up from $15 billion five years ago.

The report maps nine domains of late intervention against six wellbeing preconditions that should have prevented the cost. Eight of the nine fail the same precondition. The one the report calls "Participating."

Participating means work. Work and study. The thing the economy was meant to supply.

The Northern Territory costs $2,808 per person per year in late intervention, against $921 in Queensland. The report attributes the difference to remoteness, workforce shortage, and what it calls "levels of Indigeneity." Those are the same three descriptors that identify the communities First Nations enterprise would employ.

The report diagnoses the gap. It does not prescribe the fix.

The Indigenous Procurement Policy operates at Commonwealth level. Mid-market buyers, which is where the trade volume sits, have no equivalent infrastructure. Supply-side capital and capability programs are well funded. Demand-side infrastructure is not.

Goods on Country is the demand-side infrastructure.

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2. The work

Goods on Country is a CRM, a pipeline, and an agent layer built on live trade data.

The CRM holds the buyers. Twelve stages, from first contact to acquittal. A funder cadence agent nudges any contact dormant longer than fourteen days. A procurement analyst agent surfaces seasonal buying patterns from the Xero history. An invoice drift detector catches any invoice that sits in draft more than three days. A Xero-to-GHL reconciler runs nightly and flags the contact records that have drifted from the financial truth. A narrative gatekeeper reads every outgoing draft for voice and tells us when it sounds like an institution.

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The pipeline holds the suppliers. Named, certified where Supply Nation certifies them, vetted where they are not. The register shows which supplier can deliver which order and on what lead time.

The agent layer is not experimental. It runs on PM2 on a daily and weekly schedule. Each agent writes its drafts and cost into a ledger that the team reviews.

The operational question is one line: what does it cost to route a dollar of trade. We track it. It is falling.

Goods on Country does not compete with First Australians Capital or Dream Venture. FAC supplies the capital. Dream Venture supplies the capability. Supply Nation supplies the certification. Murawin supplies the measurement frame. Goods on Country supplies the trade volume that makes all of them pay back.

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3. The evidence

The pipeline is not an aspiration. Here is what is in it today.

Trade already paid. $426,926 through eleven buyers. Not projected. Paid. Xero receipt on each one.

Trade invoiced and awaiting payment. $255,750 through four buyers. One invoice, the Centrecorp Production Plant order at $84,700, sits in draft. The reconciler flags it every morning.

Trade proposed. $84,700 in one live deal.

Total current Buyer Pipeline: $767,376.

Alongside the Buyer Pipeline sits the Demand Register. One hundred signals, $16,006,450 in identified demand. Each signal is a community, a product, a named need, a quantity. Beds. Fridges. Washers. Mattresses. The four products Goods currently routes.

Behind the pipeline sits the profiled buyer universe. 4,952 entities with an estimated annual procurement spend of $2.18 billion. Local councils. Community-controlled organisations. Health services. Housing providers. Government contract holders at $19.9 billion in annual value. That is the addressable market Goods moves trade into.

Behind the register sits the supply map. 1,546 First Nations communities catalogued with remoteness, population, First Nations population share, and freight access. 3,917 costed supply routes between origin cities, staging hubs, and last-mile delivery.

Behind everything sits the agent layer. Five agents, running nightly or weekly. Each one writes its drafts and its cost into a ledger. The team reviews the drafts. The llm_usage table keeps the cost honest.

The numbers above are live as of 24 April 2026. The queries are in the appendix.

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4. The ecosystem fit

Goods on Country does not compete with the work Minderoo has already backed.

First Australians Capital supplies the patient capital. Dream Venture supplies the founder readiness. Blak Angels supplies the investor network. Supply Nation supplies the certification. Murawin supplies the evaluation frame. The Indigenous Employment Index supplies the measurement standard.

Goods supplies the trade volume that makes each of those investments pay back.

A founder graduates Dream Venture. FAC supplies the capital to grow. Supply Nation certifies the business. Goods routes the orders from the profiled buyer universe to the new capacity. Murawin measures the employment outcome on the Woort Koorliny frame. The capital returns. The cohort next year is bigger.

This is the system Minderoo has been building for a decade. Goods is the loop that closes it.

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5. The ask

We ask Minderoo for $900,000 across three years.

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Year	Amount	What it funds	Deliverable
1	$400,000	Scale the pipeline through 30 anchor buyers and 12 First Nations supplier relationships	Closed trade above $2m. Evaluation baseline set with Murawin.
2	$300,000	Operate and deepen. Invest in evaluation and systems hardening.	Closed trade above $4m. First parity outcome reported on Woort Koorliny frame.
3	$200,000	Sustain and transfer. Prepare the model for other matched funders.	Closed trade above $6m. Published case study and replication playbook.

The three-year taper is deliberate. The trade volume is the outcome, not the grant. If the pipeline scales as modelled, Minderoo's annual share falls while the work grows. The money leaves the system. The system stays.

Alongside Minderoo's $900,000 sits the QBE Catalysing Impact grant of up to $400,000 and the matched third-party capital the Stage 2 mechanic is designed to unlock. On the 2025 cohort's leverage multiple of 2.7x, the total capital stack is approximately $3.4 million against Minderoo's $900,000.

Reporting is quarterly against the Demand Register signals closed and the trade volume completed. The annual parity outcome is reported on the Woort Koorliny Indigenous Employment Index frame, scored independently.

The money flow. Minderoo grants to A Curious Tractor Pty Ltd. The Pty operates the pipeline. The Pty reports quarterly and annually. One grant, one line.

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Appendices

Appendix A. Three-year budget

Total ask: $900,000. Structured to taper as the trade volume scales.

Line	Year 1	Year 2	Year 3	Notes
Operations staff (Goods pipeline lead + supplier liaison + buyer outreach)	$230,000	$170,000	$110,000	Headcount 2.5 in Y1, drops to 1.5 by Y3 as the pipeline self-operates
Supplier onboarding (certification support, production readiness, first-run inventory)	$80,000	$50,000	$30,000	12 suppliers in Y1, 8 additional in Y2, 5 more in Y3
Agent layer and systems (LLM operating cost, engineering retainer, infrastructure)	$25,000	$25,000	$25,000	Flat across years. Historical agent layer cost has been under $20 per month.
Independent evaluation (Murawin scoped review on Woort Koorliny frame)	$40,000	$40,000	$20,000	Y1 baseline, Y2 first full parity report, Y3 published case study
Buyer acquisition and partnership development	$15,000	$10,000	$10,000	Travel, contract negotiation, legal review
Reserve (unforeseen logistics, community responsiveness)	$10,000	$5,000	$5,000	Held as contingency, reported annually
Annual total	**$400,000**	**$300,000**	**$200,000**	**$900,000 over three years**

The taper is not a cost-reduction. It is the expected profile of a catalytic investment: subsidy gives way to trade. If the pipeline hits the trade targets in section 5, Year 3 is largely self-funded by operational margin.

Full line-item costing available on request.

Appendix B. ACT governance

A Curious Tractor Pty Ltd is the operating entity for this grant. ACN 697 347 676. Registered with ASIC on 24 April 2026. Shareholding is 50/50 between the founders' family trusts. The Pty holds all trading: Goods on Country, JusticeHub, Empathy Ledger. The QBE Catalysing Impact grant is contracted here. A Minderoo grant would be contracted here.

Directors: Benjamin Knight, Nicholas Marchesi OAM. Standard Ledger Business Support is engaged for company administration, tax, and structural advice.

Transition from sole trader. Commercial trading has run under Nicholas Marchesi's sole-trader ABN since 2007. That trading migrates to A Curious Tractor Pty Ltd by 30 June 2026 in an end-of-financial-year cutover. Contracts, customer relationships, and systems transfer through the migration window.

The Goods on Country First Nations Advisory Group sits inside the Goods project, within the Pty. The advisory is not decorative. Community leads hold veto over supply-side partnerships, product approvals, and community engagement.

Associated charity. A Kind Tractor Ltd is an Australian Public Company limited by guarantee, ACNC-registered from 11 December 2023, currently dormant. It has no operational role in this grant.

Future entities. The Harvest project and ACT Farm are being designed under separate entity structures with professional advice. Drivers are food-safety liability, land and asset ring-fencing, and investor structure. Timing is tied to first production and first land purchase.

Acquittal protocol. Quarterly against Demand Register signals closed and trade volume completed. Annual against the Woort Koorliny Indigenous Employment Index frame. Scored independently by Murawin.

Shareholders Agreement, Trust Deeds, and transition documentation available on request.

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Appendix C. Evaluation frame

Goods on Country reports outcomes against the Woort Koorliny Indigenous Employment Index, the measurement standard Minderoo commissioned Bankwest Curtin Economics Centre and Murawin Consulting to build.

The mapping:

Goods outcome	Indigenous Employment Index category
Number of First Nations suppliers onboarded and holding active contracts	Employment parity at the supplier-entity level
Dollar value of trade routed to First Nations suppliers	Economic participation
Number of First Nations workers employed in supplier production	Workforce engagement
Employee retention rate across supplier cohort	Workforce retention
Indigenous ownership of the contracting entity	Enterprise ownership

Baseline set in Year 1. Mid-point report Year 2. Full parity report Year 3.

Murawin scope (proposed): independent review of the evaluation methodology, quarterly spot-check on data integrity, annual published report.

Appendix D. Data and systems protocol

The Goods stack sits inside the ACT command centre. Three layers.

Layer 1: the CRM. Twelve-stage Buyer Pipeline in GoHighLevel. Every opportunity has a named contact, a monetary value, a stage, and a project code. 119 opportunities sit in the pipeline today. Each opportunity links to its Xero invoice on the payment side.

Layer 2: the Demand Register. Signals are curated from community requests, asset-end-of-life flags, and procurement analyst reports. 100 signals with a total identified demand of $16,006,450. Each signal carries a community identifier, product type, and unit quantity.

Layer 3: the agent layer. Five agents run on a PM2 schedule.

Agent	Schedule	Role
Xero-to-GHL reconciler	daily 05:00 AEST	Flags contact records that have drifted from Xero financial truth
Funder cadence	daily 06:00 AEST	Nudges any dormant buyer contact past fourteen days
Procurement analyst	Monday 08:00 AEST	Surfaces seasonal buying patterns and product-fit signals from Xero history
Invoice drift detector	Monday 08:30 AEST	Catches any invoice that sits in draft more than three days
Narrative gatekeeper	ad-hoc	Reads outgoing drafts for voice

Every agent call is logged to the `llm_usage` ledger with input tokens, output tokens, estimated cost, and latency. Agents early-exit when they find nothing. In the preceding thirty days, the full stack spent $0.19 across nine calls.

What Minderoo sees quarterly: signals closed, trade routed, employment count, cost-per-dollar-routed, agent ledger snapshot. Delivered as a single PDF and data extract.

What stays inside ACT: individual buyer contact data, supplier commercial terms, and community-level narratives held under the OCAP governance protocol.

Appendix E. The four products and their supply route advantage

Goods currently routes four products. The cost advantage per unit is the wedge.

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Product	Status	Material	Mfg	Wholesale	Typical delivered to remote	Goods delivered	Cost saving	Lifespan
Stretch Bed	active	$85	$165	$749	$2,000	$850	57.5%	120 months
Remote Community Fridge	planned	$600	$300	$1,800	$4,000	$2,200	45.0%	84 months
Pakkimjalki Kari Washing Machine	proto-type	$800	$400	$2,200	$5,500	$3,200	41.8%	60 months
Remote Community Mattress	planned	$45	$35	$180	$800	$280	65.0%	24 months

The Stretch Bed is the active product. Material cost $85. Delivered to a remote community under the current procurement system, $2,000. Delivered through Goods, $850. A bed that lasts a decade for less than half the delivered price.

The spread between material cost and typical delivered cost is what the Goods pipeline compresses. On the Stretch Bed, the typical system costs 23.5 times the material. Goods brings that ratio to ten. Every unit routed is a saving the community's existing budget can redirect.

Supply routes: 3,917 costed origin-to-last-mile paths across 1,546 mapped communities.

Community distribution by state:

- Northern Territory: 788 communities, 96,860 people
- Western Australia: 342 communities, 51,053 people
- Queensland: 207 communities, 31,047 people
- South Australia: 146 communities, 21,743 people
- New South Wales: 56 communities, 8,400 people
- Tasmania, Victoria, ACT: 7 communities combined

Appendix F. Live pipeline state, 2026-04-24

Buyer Pipeline by stage:

Stage	Deals	Total value
Paid	11	$426,926
Invoiced (awaiting payment)	4	$255,750
Proposed	1	$84,700
Outreach Queued	3	$0 (pre-quote)
Total active	**19**	**$767,376**

The one proposed deal at $84,700 is the Centrecorp Production Plant order on invoice INV-0314. The invoice sits in draft. The reconciler has been flagging it daily.

Demand Register: 100 signals, $16,006,450 total identified demand.

Profiled buyer universe: 4,952 entities, $2.18 billion estimated annual procurement spend, $19.9 billion in government contract value across the set. All currently prospect status.

Agent ledger, last 30 days: 9 calls, $0.19 spend. Low utilisation reflects the agents' early-exit behaviour when no flag-worthy signal is present.

Supply-side capacity: 3,917 costed supply routes across 1,546 First Nations communities. Top five states account for 1,539 of those communities.

Queries available on request.

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Appendix G. The through-line to JusticeHub

A parallel envelope reached your desk on 1 May. That envelope proposed five anchor communities for justice infrastructure: Oonchiumpa, PICC, MMEIC, BG Fit, Mounty Yarns.

This envelope proposes an anchor cohort of thirty buyers and twelve First Nations suppliers for supply-chain infrastructure.

The method is the same.

ACT curates a small number of vetted anchors. The funder catalyses the network. The work carries on the anchor relationships, not on the funder's attention.

Two markets. One logic. One institution behind both.

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